Speaking to a car magazine in 2012, Ratan said: ‘I have a closeness and passion for Tata Motors and I’ve been involved with the company through the period it has grown from a truck manufacturer to a range of passenger cars that now includes Jaguar and Land Rover. Tata Motors is probably, out of all the group companies, the one where I have spent the most time out of my interest and passion.’

By March 2019, JLR’s financials were exemplary. *Autonews* wrote in May 2018 that from 2008 to 2017, JLR’s global sales increased by 146 per cent, it ‘rebuilt, integrated and expanded the Jaguar and Land Rover lineups’ and posted ‘eight consecutive years of profits totaling £11.4 billion ($15.9 billion)’. The EBITDA of the two brands that cost $2.3 billion (£1.15 billion) since the acquisition in FY 2009–10 until FY 2018–19 was £24.5 billion. The PAT for the above period was £8.01 billion while the gross debt, as of 31 March 2019, was £4.5 billion.

Ratan had turned around a company that had almost looked unsalvageable. Under him, the brand also won several JD Power Awards that are given for ‘products or services ranked highest in J.D. Power Consumer Studies’.

Today the Land Rover is the most sought-after automobile franchise in the US, if not in the entire world, says Gorin. Since the Land Rover was bought by the Tatas, it has been flying, ‘growing and growing’, and ‘it has been phenomenal’, feels Jordan. Under Ratan, the Blue Sky of the brand has risen dramatically, says Gorin.

JLR’s success was a personal triumph for Ratan and his answer to the analysts who had doubted his judgement in acquiring the marquee brands. As *The New York Times* reported, many had questioned ‘whether the company paid too much and extended itself too far, speculating that its chairman, Ratan Tata, a car buff and scion of the family that built the Tata group of companies, [became] too enamoured of buying global brands’. He had to face a group of sceptics who were ‘snobbish and maybe had some old colonial hangover’, said the same newspaper. His ‘success [had] stunned many analysts and investors, many of whom had said that Tata Motors’ was making an ‘expensive mistake’ in acquiring JLR.

Commenting on the role that Ratan played in expanding the group’s business in the UK, in 2010, *The Economist* opined, ‘Britain’s prime minister, David Cameron, noted that Tata was now Britain’s biggest manufacturer. Its transformation into a world-beater is largely due to Mr